

كِتَابُ الزُّهْدِ

لِلْإِمَامِ الْحَافِظِ الشَّيْخِ الْمُحَدِّثِ أَبِي حَاتِمٍ الرَّازِيِّ

az-Zuhd

by al-Imām al-Ḥāfidh Shaykh al-Muḥaddithīn
Abī Ḥātim ar-Rāzī (d. 277H)

Translated by Abū Mundhir ar-Ruwāndī



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كتاب الزهد

Kitāb az-Zuhd

The Book of Abstinence

by al-Imām al-Ḥāfiẓ

Abū Ḥātim Muḥammad ibn Idrīs al-Ḥanẓalī ar-Rāzī

(d. 277H)

Translated by

Abū Mundhir ar-Ruwāndī

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Translator's Introduction

Indeed, all praise is for Allāh. We praise Him, we seek His aid and we seek His forgiveness. We seek refuge in Allāh from the evils of our souls and from the evil of our deeds. Whomever Allāh guides, none can misguide him, and whomever He leaves astray, none can guide him. I bear witness that none has the right to be worshipped except Allāh alone, having no partner, and I bear witness that Muḥammad is His servant and His Messenger.

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ تَقَاتِهِ وَلَا تَمُوتُنَّ إِلَّا وَأَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ﴾

{O you who believe! Have taqwā of Allāh as He deserves to be feared, and do not die except as Muslims.} (Āl ʿImrān 3:102)

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ الَّذِي تَسَاءَلُونَ بِهِ وَالْأَرْحَامَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَلَيْكُمْ رَقِيبًا﴾

{O mankind! Have taqwā of your Lord, who created you from a single soul, created from it its mate, and spread from the two of them many men and women. And have taqwā of Allāh, by whom you ask one another, and [beware of severing the ties of] the wombs. Indeed, Allāh is ever, over you, an Observer.} (an-Nisā' 4:1)

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَقُولُوا قَوْلًا سَدِيدًا * يُصْلِحْ لَكُمْ أَعْمَالَكُمْ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ وَمَنْ يُطِيعِ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ فَقَدْ فَازَ فَوْزًا عَظِيمًا﴾

{O you who believe! Have taqwā of Allāh and speak a word that is correct. He will rectify your deeds for you and forgive you your sins. And whoever obeys Allāh and His Messenger has certainly attained a mighty success.} (al-Aḥzāb 33:70-71)

To proceed: the most truthful speech is the Book of Allāh, and the best guidance is the guidance of Muḥammad ﷺ. The worst of affairs are the newly-invented matters; every newly-invented matter is an innovation, every innovation is misguidance, and every misguidance is in the Fire.

Zuhd in the Book and the Sunnah

Allāh, the Most High, said: ﴿اعْلَمُوا أَنَّمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا لَعِبٌ وَهُوَ زِينَةٌ وَتَفَاخُرٌ بَيْنَكُمْ﴾

{Know that the life of this world is only play and amusement, adornment, boasting amongst yourselves, and rivalry in the increase of wealth and chil-

dren} (al-Ḥadīd 57:20). And He said: ﴿بَلْ تُوْثِرُوْنَ الْحَيٰوةَ الدُّنْيَا * وَالْآخِرَةُ خَيْرٌ وَابْقٰى﴾ {Rather, you prefer the life of this world, whilst the Hereafter is better and more lasting} (al-A'ālā 87:16–17).

‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Umar (raḍiyallāhu ‘anhumā) said: “The Messenger of Allāh ﷺ took hold of my shoulder and said: ‘Be in the dunyā as though you were a stranger or a wayfarer.’” And Ibn ‘Umar used to say: “When you reach the evening, do not wait for the morning, and when you reach the morning, do not wait for the evening. Take from your health for your sickness, and from your life for your death.” (Reported by al-Bukhārī.) And the Prophet ﷺ said: “The dunyā is the prison of the believer and the paradise of the disbeliever.” (Reported by Muslim from Abū Hurayrah.)

Yet the zuhd of the Salaf was not the forbidding of what Allāh has made lawful, nor the abandonment of earning a living, nor the wearing of rags as a display before the people. Shaykh al-Islām Ibn Taymiyyah (raḥimahullāh) said: “Zuhd is abandoning what does not benefit in the Hereafter, and wara‘ is abandoning what one fears will harm [him] in the Hereafter,” as his student Ibn al-Qayyim relates in *Madārij as-Sālikīn*. Allāh, the Most High, said: ﴿وَابْتَغِ فِيمَا ءَاتٰكَ اللّٰهُ الدّٰرَ الْآخِرَةَ وَلَا تَنْسَ نَصِيْبَكَ مِنَ الدُّنْيَا﴾ {And seek, through that which Allāh has given you, the home of the Hereafter, and do not forget your share of the world} (al-Qaṣaṣ 28:77). And the Prophet ﷺ said: “Richness is not an abundance of possessions; rather, richness is the richness of the soul.” (Reported by al-Bukhārī and Muslim from Abū Hurayrah.)

The reader will find this balance in the narrations of this very book: the clothing of Bakr ibn ‘Abd Allāh al-Muzanī reached the value of four thousand (no. 83), Wahb ibn Munabbih was the best-dressed man in Yemen (no. 97), and ‘Alī ibn al-Ḥusayn would wear a costly cloak whilst reciting: ﴿قُلْ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِيْنَةَ اللّٰهِ الَّتِيْ اَخْرَجَ لِعِبَادِهِۦ﴾ {Say: Who has forbidden the adornment of Allāh which He has brought forth for His servants?} (al-A‘rāf 7:32) (no. 96). The zuhd that is praised is that of the heart, far removed from the innovated asceticism of later times.

The Author

He is al-Imām al-Ḥāfiẓ, Shaykh al-Muḥaddithīn, Abū Ḥātim Muḥammad ibn Idrīs ibn al-Mundhir al-Ḥanẓalī ar-Rāzī (raḥimahullāh), born in 195H. He travelled at length in pursuit of ḥadīth, and it is reported from him that on his first journey he counted what he walked on foot until it exceeded a thousand farsakh, and then stopped counting. He was the companion and peer of Abū Zur‘ah ar-Rāzī, and the two of them were the foremost authorities of their age in knowledge of the narrators and the hidden defects of narrations, much of which his son ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān preserved in al-Jarḥ wat-Ta‘dīl and al-‘Ilal. He passed away in Sha‘bān of 277H.

This Book and Its Translation

Kitāb az-Zuhd is a short juz’ of one hundred and five narrations, which Abū Ḥātim relates with his own chains from the Prophet ﷺ, the Companions, the Tābi‘īn and those after them, on zuhd, death, repentance, the heart, and knowledge and action. Much of it comes from al-Ḥasan al-Baṣrī, Mālik ibn Dīnār and Wahb ibn Munabbih. Its chains vary in strength, as is the case with the books of zuhd, and I have added brief notes on the narrators to assist the reader, not to pass a final verdict on each report.

In this translation I have followed the printed edition, leaving out the editor’s introduction, footnotes and indexes, and keeping its numbering. I have translated the chains in full, added words in square brackets for clarity, and given the verses of the Qur’ān in Arabic with a translation of their meanings in braces. I have written the salutation ﷺ for the Prophet, whilst other honorifics appear only where they are in the Arabic text, and the headings in the table of contents are my own.

I ask Allāh, the Most High, to make this work sincerely for His Face, to benefit me and whoever reads it, and to grant us zuhd in the dunyā and longing for the ākhirah. And may Allāh extol and send peace upon our Prophet Muḥammad, and upon his family and his Companions.

The weak servant in need of forgiveness from his Lord,

Abū Mundhir ar-Ruwāndī

15 Rabī‘ ath-Thānī, 1448H

28 September, 2026

Kitāb az-Zuhd

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the Name of Allāh, the Most Merciful, the Bestower of Mercy.

Ash-Shaykh Abū Ṭāhir, Muḥammad ibn al-Ḥusayn ibn Muḥammad ibn Ibrāhīm al-Ḥinnāʾī,¹ informed us, by my reading [it] to him, saying: Al-Qāḍī Abū al-Ḥasan, ʿAbd al-ʿAzīz ibn Abī al-Qāsim ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān ibn Aḥmad al-Ḥabbārī,² informed us, by [way of] reading to him whilst I was listening, in Ṣafar of the year four hundred and forty-three, saying: My father informed me, by my reading to him, in al-Muḥarram of the year three hundred and ninety-three, saying: Abū al-Ḥasan, ʿAlī ibn Ibrāhīm ibn Salamah al-Qaṭṭān,³ informed us, by [way of] reading to him, saying:

(1) Abū Ḥātim, Muḥammad ibn Idrīs al-Ḥanzalī ar-Rāzī,⁴ narrated to us, saying: Abū Nuʿaym⁵ narrated to us, saying: Misʿar⁶ narrated to us, from Saʿīd ibn Abī Burdah, from al-Aswad, from ʿĀʾishah, who said: “Indeed you are neglecting the most excellent [act of] worship: humility.”

1. Abū Ṭāhir al-Ḥinnāʾī ad-Dimashqī (d. 510H), a muḥaddith of Damascus.

2. Abū al-Ḥasan ʿAbd al-ʿAzīz ibn ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān al-Qazwīnī, a Shāfiʿī faqīh. The nisbah is printed without vowels (الجبّاري), so its vocalisation here is tentative.

3. ʿAlī ibn Ibrāhīm ibn Salamah al-Qaṭṭān al-Qazwīnī (d. 345H), best known as the transmitter of the Sunan of Ibn Mājah.

4. The author, al-Imām al-Ḥāfiẓ Abū Ḥātim Muḥammad ibn Idrīs ibn al-Mundhir al-Ḥanzalī ar-Rāzī (d. 277H), one of the foremost imāms of ḥadīth and of al-jarḥ wat-taʿdīl.

5. Abū Nuʿaym al-Faḍl ibn Dukayn al-Kūfī (d. 218 or 219H), a trustworthy and precise ḥāfiẓ and one of the most senior shaykhs of Abū Ḥātim. He is the “Ibn Dukayn” who appears in the chains that follow.

6. Misʿar ibn Kidām al-Kūfī (d. 153 or 155H), a trustworthy and precise narrator.

(2) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Dukayn narrated to us, saying: Miṣ-‘ar narrated to us, from Abū Bakr ibn Ḥafṣ, who said: “On the day of Badr, Ibn Fuṣḥum had some dates in his hand. So he cast them away and said: ‘These [belong] with the dunyā (this worldly life).’ Then he advanced and fought until he was killed.”⁷

(3) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Dukayn narrated to us, saying: Miṣ-‘ar narrated to us, from ‘Amr ibn Murrah, from Mujāhid,⁸ who said: “‘Īsā (‘alayhis-salām) used to eat [the leaves of] trees, wear [garments of] hair,⁹ and spend the night wherever the evening overtook him. He would not store away anything for the morrow, and he had no child who might die, nor any house that might fall to ruin.”

(4) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥasan ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Ismā‘īl ibn ‘Ayyāsh¹⁰ narrated to us, from Zayd ibn Aslam,¹¹ “That Mūsā asked his Lord, so he said: ‘O my Lord, who are those who will inherit the Abode of Your Holiness?’ He said: ‘O Mūsā, they are those whose hands are clean and whose hearts are pure; those who, when I am mentioned, remember [Me], and when they remember Me, I remember them; those who love one another for the sake of My Majesty, who populate My mosques, and who seek forgiveness in the pre-dawn hours (al-ashḥār); those who turn back to My remembrance just as eagles turn back to their nests (wukūr); and those who become angered when My sacred limits are violated, just as the leopard becomes angered when it is enraged (ḥarib).”

7. The well-known report of a man at Badr who threw away his dates and fought until he was killed concerns ‘Umayr ibn al-Ḥumām, as reported by Muslim in his *Ṣaḥīḥ*. The name printed here, Ibn Fuṣḥum, does not match it, and the reading may be a scribal corruption.

8. Mujāhid ibn Jabr al-Makkī (d. c. 104H), the famous student of Ibn ‘Abbās in tafsīr.

9. Ash-sha‘r: coarse cloth woven from hair, worn by ascetics.

10. Ismā‘īl ibn ‘Ayyāsh al-‘Ansī al-Ḥimṣī (d. 181 or 182H). The critics held his narrations from the people of his own land, Shām, to be sound, and weakened what he narrated from others, such as the people of al-Ḥijāz and ‘Irāq.

11. Zayd ibn Aslam al-‘Adawī al-Madanī (d. 136H), the freed slave of ‘Umar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb, a trustworthy scholar.

(5) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥasan narrated to us, saying: Ismāʿīl narrated to us, from Sulaymān ibn Sulaym, “That a questioner asked Yaʿqūb, so he said: ‘What is [the cause of] the emaciation (nuḥūl) of your body and the drooping of your eyebrows over your eyes?’ He said: ‘The length of time and the abundance of sorrows.’ So Allāh, the Blessed and Most High, revealed to him: ‘O Yaʿqūb, do you complain about Me to My servants?’ He said: ‘O my Lord, [it is] a mistake that I committed and a sin that I perpetrated, so forgive me.’”

(6) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, from Ismāʿīl, from Thaʿlabah ibn Muslim, from Abū ʿImrān al-Anṣārī, “That al-Masīḥ (ʿalay-his-salām) said: ‘O company of disciples (ḥawāriyyūn), if you love to be among the chosen elect of Allāh and the light of the children of Ādam from among His creation, then set things right between people, and love those who hate you.’”

He said: And I heard one of those who read the [earlier] Books [say]: It is written in the Injīl (Gospel): “Successful are those who set things right between people; they are the special ones of Allāh from among His creation.”

(7) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Ismāʿīl ibn ʿAyyāsh narrated to us, from Ṣafwān ibn ʿAmr,¹² that Yazīd ibn Maysarah said: “It is said to the one possessing authority: ‘O you who have been given dominion (al-musallaṭ), let not the heady spirit of authority puff you up. For you were only created from dust, and to dust you shall return. You have inherited the place of whoever was before you, and someone other than you will inherit your place tomorrow.’”

12. Ṣafwān ibn ʿAmr as-Saksakī al-Ḥimṣī (d. 155H), trustworthy. Being a Ḥimṣī, he is among the people of Ismāʿīl ibn ʿAyyāsh’s own land.

(8) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Ismā‘īl narrated to us, from Sulaymān ibn Sulaym al-Kinānī, from Yaḥyā ibn Jābir, who said: “Abū ad-Dardā¹³ went out to a funeral, and he saw the family of the deceased weeping over him. So he said: ‘Poor wretches! The dead of tomorrow weeping over the dead of today?!’”

(9) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Kathīr ibn Sulaym¹⁴ narrated to us, from al-Ḥasan,¹⁵ concerning His saying: ﴿فَإِنَّهُ كَانَ لِلْأَوَّابِينَ غُفُورًا﴾ {Then indeed, He is ever, towards the *awwābīn*, Oft-For-giving} (al-Isrā’ 17:25), he said: “[They are] those who repent (at-tawwābīn).”

(10) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Jasr¹⁶ narrated to us, from ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Abī ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān, “That they asked the Mother of the Believers, ‘Ā’ishah, concerning His saying in [the Sūrah of] al-Malā’ikah:¹⁷ ﴿ثُمَّ أَوْرَثْنَا الْكِتَابَ﴾ {Then We caused the Book to be inherited [by those whom We chose from Our servants; so among them is he who wrongs himself, among them is he who is moderate, and among them is he who is foremost in good deeds by the permission of Allāh]} (Fāṭir 35:32). She said: ‘The one who is foremost in good deeds is Muḥammad ﷺ; the one who is moderate is his Companions; and the one who wrongs himself is the likes of me, the likes of you, and the likes of this [person].’”

(11) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Jasr narrated to us, saying: an-Nu‘mān ibn Abī Bakr ibn Anas narrated to us, from Anas ibn Mālīk, who said: “[Anas] went out to a funeral, and he prayed two light rak‘ahs, then reclined beside a grave. Anas then dozed off, and the occu-

13. Abū ad-Dardā’ ‘Uwaymir ibn Zayd al-Anṣārī, the Companion, who died in Damascus in 32H.

14. Kathīr ibn Sulaym aḍ-Ḍabbī, a narrator whom the critics graded weak.

15. Al-Ḥasan ibn Abī al-Ḥasan al-Baṣrī (d. 110H), the renowned Tābi‘ī, imām and preacher of Baṣrah. “Al-Ḥasan” unqualified in this book refers to him.

16. Most likely Jasr ibn Farqad al-Baṣrī, a narrator whom the critics graded weak.

17. Sūrat al-Malā’ikah is another name for Sūrah Fāṭir.

pant of the grave came out to him and said: ‘It is as if you took your two rak‘ahs lightly just now. That we should be able to do the like of them is more beloved to us than such-and-such. Indeed you [the living] act but do not know, whereas we know but are not able to act.’”

(12) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Jasr narrated to us, from al-Ḥasan, who said: “Son of Ādam! Tread the earth with your foot, for in a little while it will be your grave. By Allāh, you have not ceased demolishing your lifespan from the day you dropped from your mother’s womb.”

(13) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṭarīf narrated to us, saying: Jasr narrated to us, saying: “Al-Ḥasan was beside an-Naḍr ibn ‘Amr in the maqṣūrah,¹⁸ and an-Naḍr was the governor (amīr) of Baṣrah. So al-Ḥasan said: ‘I reached the first generation of this Ummah: they would sleep upon their limbs, spreading out their faces [upon the ground in prostration], their tears having run down their cheeks, privately calling upon their Lord for the ransoming of their necks [from the Fire]. When they committed an evil deed, it distressed them and grieved them, and they called upon Allāh to forgive them. By Allāh, those people were not free from sins, and they were only saved through forgiveness.’

Then he turned to an-Naḍr ibn ‘Amr and said to him: ‘Yet you, by Allāh, have come to oppose those people in [both] deeds and conduct. So beware of swaying about in wishful hopes (al-amānī), for how far your description is from the description of those people! Indeed your [true] brother is the one who sincerely advises you, and the one who sincerely advises you is better for you than the one who deludes you and fills you with false hopes. [Seek] safety, safety! Haste, haste! By the Lord of the Ka‘bah, upon what are you tarrying?!¹⁹

18. Al-maqṣūrah: the screened-off enclosure in the front of the mosque reserved for the ruler.

19. Reading the printed ما تعرجون *alāma tu‘arrijūn*, “at what are you stopping over [on the road]?”

So sever the ropes of the dunyā from yourselves, and close its doors upon yourselves. It is as though you are a caravan that has halted: whenever one of you is called, he answers.”

(14) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Uwaysī²⁰ narrated to us, saying: Ibn Abī az-Zinād²¹ narrated to us, from Hishām ibn ‘Urwah,²² from his father, from ‘Ā’ishah, who said: “The bedding of the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ was of tanned leather (adam), its stuffing being palm fibre (lif).”

Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Uwaysī narrated to us, saying: Ibn Abī az-Zinād narrated to us, from Hishām, from his father, from ‘Ā’ishah: “Similar to it.”

(15) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Uwaysī narrated to us, saying: Ibn Abī az-Zinād narrated to us, from Mūsā ibn ‘Uqbah,²³ from a man from the offspring of ‘Ubādah ibn aṣ-Ṣāmit, from Abū Hurayrah: that the Prophet ﷺ said: “The Angel of Death attended a man who was dying. So he split open his limbs, but did not find that he had done any good. Then he split open his heart, but did not find any good in it. Then he parted his two jaws, and found the tip of his tongue cleaving to his palate, saying: Lā ilāha illallāh.” He ﷺ said: “So he was forgiven on account of the word of sincerity (kalimat al-ikhhlās).”

20. ‘Abd al-‘Azīz ibn ‘Abd Allāh al-Uwaysī al-Madanī, a trustworthy narrator and one of the shaykhs of al-Bukhārī.

21. ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Abī az-Zinād al-Madanī (d. 174H).

22. Hishām ibn ‘Urwah ibn az-Zubayr (d. 146H), who narrates from his father, ‘Urwah ibn az-Zubayr (d. 94H), one of the seven fuqahā’ of al-Madīnah and the nephew of ‘Ā’ishah.

23. Mūsā ibn ‘Uqbah al-Madanī (d. 141H), the trustworthy imām, author of the well-known al-Maghāzī.

And the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ said: “Allāh, the Mighty and Majestic, commanded that a servant be taken to the Fire. When he stood at its edge, he turned and said: ‘By Allāh, O my Lord, my thought of You was indeed good!’ So Allāh, the Mighty and Majestic, said: ‘Bring him back, for I am [in accordance] with My servant’s good thought of Me.’ So he was entered into Paradise.”

(16) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Uwaysī narrated to us, saying: Sulaymān ibn Bilāl²⁴ narrated to us, from Muḥammad ibn Abī Ḥumayd,²⁵ from ‘Awn ibn ‘Abd Allāh,²⁶ from his father, from ‘Abd Allāh ibn Mas‘ūd, who said: the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ said: “There is no believing servant from whose eye tears come out from the fear of Allāh, even if [they be] like the head of a fly, and then they touch something [of his face], except that Allāh makes him forbidden for the Fire.”

(17) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Umar al-Ḥawḍī²⁷ narrated to us, saying: al-Mubārak ibn Faḍālah²⁸ narrated to us, from al-Ḥasan: ﴿أَمَّنْ هُوَ قَتَّاءَ اللَّيْلِ﴾ {Is one who is devoutly obedient during the hours of the night [like one who is not]?} (az-Zumar 39:9), he said: “The hours of the night: its beginning, its end and its middle.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿وَتَأْكُلُونَ التَّرَاثَ﴾ {And you devour the inheritance} (al-Fajr 89:19), he said: “The inheritance: [devouring] his own share and the share of his companion, its lawful and its unlawful.”

24. Sulaymān ibn Bilāl al-Madanī (d. 177H), a trustworthy narrator.

25. Muḥammad ibn Abī Ḥumayd al-Anṣārī al-Madanī, whom the critics graded weak.

26. ‘Awn ibn ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Utbah ibn Mas‘ūd al-Hudhalī al-Kūfī, the devout Tābi‘ī known for his preaching. His father, ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Utbah, was the nephew of ‘Abd Allāh ibn Mas‘ūd.

27. Abū ‘Umar Ḥafṣ ibn ‘Umar al-Ḥawḍī al-Baṣrī (d. 225H), a trustworthy narrator and one of the shaykhs of al-Bukhārī.

28. Al-Mubārak ibn Faḍālah al-Baṣrī (d. 166H), who kept the company of al-Ḥasan for many years and narrated a great deal from him.

And concerning His saying: ﴿فَلَوْلَا أَنَّهُ كَانَ مِنَ الْمُسِخِّينَ﴾ {And had he not been of those who glorify [Allāh], [he would have remained inside its belly until the Day they are resurrected]} (aṣ-Ṣāffāt 37:143), he said: “Had it not been that he had put forward righteous action [beforehand], he would have remained in its belly.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿كَذَلِكَ نَبْلُوهُمْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْسُقُونَ﴾ {Thus did We put them to trial because of what they used to do of rebellious disobedience} (al-Aʿrāf 7:163), he said: “Because of the sins that they used to commit before that.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿الْلُّؤْلُؤُ وَالْمَرْجَانُ﴾ {The pearls and the marjān} (ar-Raḥmān 55:22), he said: “Al-luʿluʿ is the large ones and al-marjān is the small ones.”²⁹

And concerning His saying: ﴿وَإِذَا أَرَدْنَا أَنْ نُهْلِكَ قَرْيَةً أَمَرْنَا مُتْرَفِيهَا﴾ {And when We intend to destroy a township, We command its affluent ones [...]} (al-Isrāʾ 17:16), he said: “When the people of Jāhiliyyah became many, they would say: amira Banū fulān (the tribe of so-and-so has become numerous).”³⁰

And concerning His saying: ﴿وَإِنَّا لَجَاعِلُونَ مَا عَلَيْهَا صَعِيدًا جُرُزًا﴾ {And indeed, We will make whatever is upon it a barren, bare ground} (al-Kāhf 18:8), he said: “There will be nothing upon it.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿تَوْبُوا إِلَى اللَّهِ تَوْبَةً نَصُوحًا﴾ {Repent to Allāh with a sincere repentance} (at-Taḥrīm 66:8), he said: “He abandons the sin and then does not return to it.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿وَكُلَّ إِنْسَانٍ أَلْزَمْنَاهُ طَبْعَهُ فِي عُنُقِهِ﴾ {And [for] every person We have fastened his ṭāʿir upon his neck} (al-Isrāʾ 17:13), he said: “[It is] his deeds.”

29. Al-marjān is commonly rendered as “coral.” Al-Ḥasan explains it here as the small pearls.

30. Al-Ḥasan is explaining the word amarnā from the usage of the Arabs, in which amira means “to increase and become numerous.” On this explanation the sense is: We multiply its affluent ones.

And concerning His saying: ﴿لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ﴾ {*[Ibrāhīm was] indeed awwāh*} (at-Tawbah 9:114; cf. Hūd 11:75), he said: “The one who is merciful to the servants of Allāh.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿قُطُوفُهَا دَانِيَةٌ﴾ {*Its clusters of fruit hanging low*} (al-Ḥāqqah 69:23), he said: “They draw near to him, such that he can take hold of them from wherever he wishes.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿وَمِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ بَرْزَخٌ إِلَى يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ﴾ {*And behind them is a barrier until the Day they are resurrected*} (al-Mu'minūn 23:100), he said: “The graves.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿فَهَلْ يَنْتَظِرُونَ إِلَّا مِثْلَ أَيَّامِ الَّذِينَ خَلَوْا مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ﴾ {*So do they await except the like of the days of those who passed away before them?*} (Yūnus 10:102), he said: “They were made to fear the punishment.” Then he said: ﴿بَلِ السَّاعَةُ مَوْعِدُهُمْ وَالسَّاعَةُ أَدْهَىٰ وَأَمَرُّ﴾ {*Rather, the Hour is their appointment, and the Hour is more calamitous and more bitter*} (al-Qamar 54:46).

And concerning His saying: ﴿ذَرَأْنَا لِجَهَنَّمَ﴾ {*We have dhara'nā for Hell [many of the jinn and mankind]*} (al-A'rāf 7:179), he said: “We have created for Hell.”

And concerning His saying: ﴿فَلَمَّا ءَاسَفُونَا﴾ {*So when they āsafūnā*} (az-Zukhruf 43:55), he said: “[When] they angered Us.”

(18) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū 'Umar al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Yazīd ibn Ibrāhīm at-Tustarī³¹ narrated to us, saying: I heard al-Ḥasan narrating from Ubayy ibn Ka'b, who said: “Indeed, the food of the son of Ādam has been struck as a parable for the dunyā, even if he spices it and salts it.”³²

(19) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Yazīd narrated to us, saying: I heard al-Ḥasan say: “When death came to Salmān, he wept. So it was said to him: ‘What makes you weep, O Abū 'Abd Allāh?’ He said:

31. Yazīd ibn Ibrāhīm at-Tustarī al-Baṣrī (d. 161H), a trustworthy and precise narrator from al-Ḥasan.

32. That is: however much he seasons and flavours it, look at what it finally turns into. This conclusion is stated outright in other versions of this report.

‘By Allāh, I do not weep out of anguish at death, nor out of greed [for the dunyā]. Rather, I only weep because the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ took a covenant from us, saying: “It suffices one of you from the dunyā [to take] the like of a rider’s provision.””

(20) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Yazīd narrated to us, saying: and I heard al-Ḥasan say: Abū ad-Dardā’ said: “Son of Ādam! Act as though you see Him, count yourself amongst the dead, and beware of the supplication of the one who has been wronged.”

Al-Ḥasan said: And Abū ad-Dardā’ said: “Whoever does not recognise the favour of Allāh upon him except in his food and his drink, then his deeds have become few and his punishment has drawn near.”

(21) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Yazīd ibn Ṭahmān narrated to us — Abū Ḥātim said: he is al-Mu‘tamir³³ — he said: I heard al-Ḥasan say: “Your best ones are departing, whilst you, every day, are becoming more base.”

(22) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: aḍ-Ḍaḥḥāk ibn Yasār narrated to us — Abū Ḥātim said: [he is] an old shaykh — from ‘Ubādah ibn Nusayy,³⁴ that it reached him “That Mūsā (‘alayhis-salām) performed Ḥajj upon a red she-camel, and that ‘Īsā (‘alayhis-salām) performed Ḥajj upon his riding-mount, or upon an ox.”

(23) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Umar al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: al-Mundhir ibn Tha‘labah narrated to us, from Ḥawshab, from al-Ḥasan, who said: “Indeed the heart is swifter in flitting about than a feather on a stormy day.”

33. Yazīd ibn Ṭahmān ar-Raqāshī al-Baṣrī, who is known by the kunyah Abū al-Mu‘tamir.

34. ‘Ubādah ibn Nusayy al-Kindī ash-Shāmī (d. 118H), the qāḍī of Ṭabariyyah, a trustworthy narrator.

(24) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Shu‘bah³⁵ narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-Malik ibn Maysarah, from Abū al-Aḥwas,³⁶ from ‘Abd Allāh:³⁷ ﴿حُورٌ مَّقْصُورَاتٌ فِي الْخِيَامِ﴾ {*Hūr, restrained within pavilions*} (ar-Raḥmān 55:72), he said: “[The pavilions are] hollowed-out pearls.”

(25) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād ibn Zayd³⁸ narrated to us, from Hishām ibn Ḥassān,³⁹ from al-Ḥasan, who said: “How many a wicked hand has intended [evil], yet Allāh prevented it and restrained it.”

Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: “This is from the choicest of reports (ghurar al-ḥadīth).”

(26) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Umar al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: al-Mubārak narrated to us, from al-Ḥasan, who said: ﴿أَنْكَالًا﴾ {*ankāl*} (al-Muzzammil 73:12), he said: “Fetters.”

(27) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Sallām ibn Miskīn⁴⁰ narrated to us, saying: “Al-Ḥasan recited this verse: ﴿لَأَحْتَنِكَ زُرِّيَهُ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا﴾ {*I will surely bring his descendants under my sway, except for a few*} (al-Isrā’ 17:62).⁴¹ He said: ‘[He said it] when he made his attempt upon Ādam, and threw him down with that fall.’”

(28) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, from al-Mubārak, from al-Ḥasan: ﴿مُتَكِنِينَ فِيهَا عَلَى الْأَرَائِكِ﴾ {*Reclining therein upon al-arā’ik*} (al-Kahf 18:31; al-Insān 76:13), he said: “The couches within the ḥijāl.”⁴²

35. Shu‘bah ibn al-Ḥajjāj al-Wāsiṭī al-Baṣrī (d. 160H), Amīr al-Mu‘minīn in ḥadīth.

36. Abū al-Aḥwas ‘Awf ibn Mālik al-Jushamī al-Kūfī, one of the companions of ‘Abd Allāh ibn Mas‘ūd.

37. ‘Abd Allāh unqualified in chains of this kind refers to ‘Abd Allāh ibn Mas‘ūd.

38. Ḥammād ibn Zayd al-Azdī al-Baṣrī (d. 179H), the trustworthy and precise imām.

39. Hishām ibn Ḥassān al-Qurdūsī al-Baṣrī (d. 147 or 148H), a trustworthy narrator.

40. Sallām ibn Miskīn al-Azdī al-Baṣrī (d. 167H), a trustworthy narrator.

41. The words of Iblīs. Aḥtanikanna comes from placing a rope in the jaw of an animal to lead it, and is also used for a swarm of locusts stripping land bare.

(29) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, from al-Mubārak, from al-Ḥasan, who said: “They used to say: ‘O Messenger of Allāh, indeed we love Allāh.’ So Allāh wished to set up a sign (‘alam) for their love of Him, and so Allāh, the Mighty and Majestic, sent down: ﴿إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي﴾ {If you [truly] love Allāh, then follow me, [Allāh will love you and forgive you your sins]} (Āl ‘Imrān 3:31), [to the end of] the verse.”

(30) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Shu‘bah narrated to us, from ‘Awf,⁴³ from a man, from Wahb ibn Munabbih,⁴⁴ who said: “From the traits of the hypocrite: he loves praise and hates censure.”

(31) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Shu‘bah narrated to us, from Sharqī, who said: I heard ‘Ikrimah⁴⁵ [say regarding]: ﴿يَعْلَمُونَ ظَهْرًا مِّنَ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا﴾ {They know what is apparent of the worldly life} (ar-Rūm 30:7), he said: “The occupations.” And he mentioned the lamp (as-sirāj) and the like of it.⁴⁶

(32) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Awānah⁴⁷ narrated to us, from Sulaymān al-A‘mash,⁴⁸ from Muḥammad ibn ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Yazīd, from Abū al-Aḥwaṣ, from ‘Abd Allāh, who said: “Whatever [illicit] glance there is, then Shayṭān has some hope of gain in it.”

42. Al-ḥijāl, plural of ḥajalah: a curtained canopy, such as the one set up over a bride.

43. ‘Awf ibn Abī Jamīlah al-A‘rābī al-Baṣrī (d. 146 or 147H).

44. Wahb ibn Munabbih al-Yamānī (d. after 110H), the Ṭābi‘ī known for his extensive knowledge of the reports of the earlier scriptures.

45. ‘Ikrimah, the freed slave of Ibn ‘Abbās (d. 104 or 105H), one of the scholars of tafsīr among the Ṭābi‘īn.

46. That is: the worldly crafts and skills in which people excel, such as the making of lamps, whilst they are heedless of the Hereafter, as the rest of the verse states.

47. Abū ‘Awānah al-Waḍḍāḥ ibn ‘Abd Allāh al-Yashkurī al-Wāsiṭī (d. 175 or 176H), a trustworthy narrator.

48. Sulaymān ibn Mihrān al-A‘mash al-Kūfī (d. 147 or 148H), the trustworthy ḥāfiẓ and Qur’ān reciter.

(33) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Ṣālih Abū Khuzaymah narrated to us, saying: I heard al-Ḥasan say: ﴿ذَلِكَ مَا كُنْتَ مِنْهُ نَحِيدُ﴾ {That is what you used to flee from} (Qāf 50:19), he said: “[This is] one who was a transgressor (fāsiq) in life, a corrupter at death.”

(34) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Shuḥbah narrated to us, from ‘Amr ibn Murrah, from Abū Wā’il,⁴⁹ from Kurdūs ibn ‘Amr — Abū Ḥātim said: Kurdūs is Abū Nu‘aym, and he used to read the [earlier] Books — he said: he finds it in what he reads of the Books: “Indeed, Allāh, the Blessed and Most High, tests the servant whilst He loves him, in order to hear his humble entreaty.”

(35) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Yazīd ibn Ibrāhīm narrated to us, saying: Ibn Sīrīn⁵⁰ narrated to us, saying: I was informed that a man from the Anṣār, whenever the prayer was at hand, would say: “Perform wuḍū’, for some of what you say is worse than ḥadath.”⁵¹

(36) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Shuḥbah narrated to us, from Abū Ishāq,⁵² from a man from Banū Tamīm, from Ibn ‘Abbās, concerning His saying: ﴿فَنَادَوْا وَلَاتَ حِينَ مَنَاصٍ﴾ {And they called out, when it was no longer a time for escape} (Ṣād 38:3), he said: “A time when there is neither leaping forth nor fleeing.” And concerning His saying: ﴿وَأَنَّى لَهُمُ التَّنَاقُصُ﴾ {But how could they attain [it]} (Saba’ 34:52), he said: “The return (ar-radd).”⁵³

49. Abū Wā’il Shaqīq ibn Salamah al-Asadī al-Kūfī, the senior Tābi‘ī.

50. Muḥammad ibn Sīrīn al-Anṣārī al-Baṣrī (d. 110H), the renowned Tābi‘ī.

51. Ḥadath: that which nullifies wuḍū’, such as passing wind.

52. Abū Ishāq ‘Amr ibn ‘Abd Allāh as-Sabī‘ī al-Hamdānī al-Kūfī (d. 129H).

53. That is: how could they be granted a return to the dunyā, when they are asking for it after the matter has been decided?

(37) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: al-Mubārak ibn Faḍālah narrated to us, from ‘Ubayd Allāh ibn Abī Bakr,⁵⁴ from Anas, from the Prophet ﷺ, that he said — meaning [relating from] the Lord, the Blessed and Most High —: “Whoever remembered Me for a day, or feared Me in a [single] situation, shall be brought out of the Fire.”

(38) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥawḍī narrated to us, saying: Yazīd ibn Ibrāhīm narrated to us, saying: I heard Bakr ibn ‘Abd Allāh al-Muzanī⁵⁵ narrating: “That a woman from the people of Yemen, when she entered upon the morning, would say: ‘O soul! Today is your day; you have no day besides it.’ Then she would act in that day as much as Allāh willed that she should act. And when she entered upon the evening, she would say: ‘O soul! Tonight is your night; you have no night besides it.’ Then she would act in that night as much as Allāh willed that she should act, until the morning came. And that remained her custom until she passed away.”

(39) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Ibrāhīm ibn Khālīd narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-‘Azīz — the in-law (khatan) of ‘Uthmān ibn Zā’idah⁵⁶ — he said: Sufyān ath-Thawrī⁵⁷ said: “Keep your heart away from doubt (ar-rayb) and from whatever you fear will corrupt it.”

54. ‘Ubayd Allāh ibn Abī Bakr ibn Anas ibn Mālik al-Anṣārī, the grandson of Anas, a trustworthy narrator.

55. Bakr ibn ‘Abd Allāh al-Muzanī al-Baṣrī (d. 106 or 108H), a trustworthy and devout Tābi‘ī.

56. Khatan: a relative by marriage, most often a son-in-law.

57. Sufyān ibn Sa‘īd ath-Thawrī al-Kūfī (d. 161H), Amīr al-Mu‘minīn in ḥadīth, and one of the greatest imāms of the Salaf in knowledge and zuhd.

(40) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ḥaywah ibn Shurayḥ⁵⁸ narrated to me, saying: Ismā‘īl ibn ‘Ayyāsh narrated to us, from Yaḥyā ibn Sa‘īd al-Anṣārī,⁵⁹ who said: “It has reached me that the gates of the heaven are opened for a man on the night of his marriage (laylat al-milāk), and it is said concerning him: ‘He desired to keep chaste from what Allāh has made unlawful.’”

(41) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah ibn Khālīd⁶⁰ narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād ibn Salamah⁶¹ narrated to us, from ‘Āṣim ibn Bahdalah,⁶² from Abū Ṣāliḥ,⁶³ from Abū Hurayrah, concerning this verse: ﴿لَتَبْنَ فِيهَا أَحْقَابًا﴾ {In which they will remain for aḥqāb} (an-Naba’ 78:23), he said: “The ḥuqb is eighty years.”

(42) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād narrated to us, from ‘Ammār ibn Abī ‘Ammār, from Ibn ‘Abbās, who said: “The Witnessed [Day] (al-mashhūd) is the Day of Resurrection, and the Promised [Day] (al-maw‘ūd) is the Day of Resurrection.”⁶⁴ And he recited: ﴿وَذَلِكَ يَوْمَ يَجْمَعُ لَهُ النَّاسُ وَذَلِكَ يَوْمَ مَشْهُودٍ﴾ {That is a Day for which mankind will be gathered together, and that is a Day [which will be] witnessed} (Hūd 11:103).

58. Ḥaywah ibn Shurayḥ ibn Yazīd al-Ḥaḍramī al-Ḥimṣī (d. 224H), a trustworthy narrator, not to be confused with the older Egyptian Ḥaywah ibn Shurayḥ.

59. Yaḥyā ibn Sa‘īd al-Anṣārī al-Madanī (d. 144H), the trustworthy imām. Being a Madanī, he is not from the people of Ismā‘īl ibn ‘Ayyāsh’s own land (see the note to no. 4).

60. Hudbah ibn Khālīd al-Qaysī al-Baṣrī (d. 235H), a trustworthy narrator and one of the shaykhs of al-Bukhārī and Muslim.

61. Ḥammād ibn Salamah al-Baṣrī (d. 167H), the trustworthy imām. “Ḥammād” in the chains of Hudbah that follow refers to him.

62. ‘Āṣim ibn Bahdalah, who is ‘Āṣim ibn Abī an-Najūd al-Kūfī (d. 128H), the famous imām of Qur’ānic recitation.

63. Abū Ṣāliḥ Dhakwān as-Sammān al-Madanī (d. 101H), a trustworthy Ṭābi‘ī and companion of Abū Hurayrah.

64. Referring to His saying: “And [by] the Promised Day, and [by] the witness and the witnessed” (al-Burūj 85:2-3).

(43) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād narrated to us, from Ḥumayd,⁶⁵ from al-Ḥasan: ﴿فَلَا تَسْمَعُ إِلَّا هَمْسًا﴾ {So you will not hear except a faint sound} (Ṭāhā 20:108), he said: “The soft tread of their feet.”

(44) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād narrated to us, from Thābit,⁶⁶ from ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Abī Laylā,⁶⁷ concerning this verse: ﴿قَالُوا يَوَلَّيْنَا مِنْ بَعَثْنَا مِنْ مَرْقَدِنَا﴾ {They will say: Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of sleep?} (Yā Sīn 36:52), [to the end of] the verse: “The disbeliever will say: ﴿يَوَلَّيْنَا مِنْ بَعَثْنَا مِنْ مَرْقَدِنَا﴾ {Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of sleep?} (Yā Sīn 36:52). And the believers will say: ﴿هَذَا مَا وَعَدَ الرَّحْمَنُ وَصَدَقَ الْمُرْسَلُونَ﴾ {This is what the Most Merciful promised, and the Messengers spoke the truth} (Yā Sīn 36:52).”

(45) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād narrated to us, from ‘Aṭā’,⁶⁸ from Sa‘īd ibn Jubayr,⁶⁹ from Ibn ‘Abbās: ﴿وَنَحْنُ أَقْرَبُ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ حَبْلِ الْوَرِيدِ﴾ {And We are nearer to him than [his] jugular vein} (Qāf 50:16), he said: “The niyāṭ of the heart and what it carries.”⁷⁰

(46) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād narrated to us, from ‘Aṭā’ ibn as-Sā’ib, from Abū ‘Iyāḍ, “That whenever the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ recited: ﴿فَكَيْفَ إِذَا جِئْنَا مِنْ كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ بِشَهِيدٍ وَجِئْنَا بِكَ﴾ {So how [will it be] when We bring from every nation a witness, and We bring you as a witness against these?} (an-Nisā’ 4:41), he would weep.”

65. Ḥumayd aṭ-Ṭawil al-Baṣrī (d. 142 or 143H).

66. Thābit ibn Aslam al-Bunānī al-Baṣrī (d. c. 127H), the trustworthy and devout companion of Anas.

67. ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Abī Laylā al-Anṣārī al-Kūfī (d. 83H), the senior Tābi‘ī.

68. ‘Aṭā’ ibn as-Sā’ib al-Kūfī (d. 136H), whose memory deteriorated in his later years.

69. Sa‘īd ibn Jubayr al-Asadī al-Kūfī, the student of Ibn ‘Abbās, killed by al-Ḥajjāj in 95H.

70. Ibn ‘Abbās is explaining ḥabl al-warīd. Niyāṭ al-qalb is the great vessel from which the heart is suspended. As for the nearness mentioned in the verse, Ibn Kathīr and others among the scholars of tafsīr explain it as the nearness of His angels, as indicated by the verse after it.

(47) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Hammām⁷¹ narrated to us, from Qatādah,⁷² from al-Ḥasan, who said: “It has reached us that the angels rejoice for the believer at [the coming of] winter: that its night is long, so he stands [in prayer] in it, and that its day is short, so he fasts it.”

(48) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥazm⁷³ narrated to us, saying: I heard Mālik ibn Dīnār⁷⁴ say: “I am more fearful of the wicked reciter (al-qārī’ al-fājir)⁷⁵ than I am of the wicked person who openly displays his wickedness; indeed, this one is the more deeply hidden of the two.”

(49) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Sallām narrated to us — meaning Ibn Abī Muṭī’⁷⁶ — he said: I heard Ayyūb as-Sakhtiyānī⁷⁷ say: “There is no wicked one more wicked than a wicked reciter.”

(50) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥazm narrated to us, saying: “We entered upon Mālik ibn Dīnār during the illness in which he died, whilst he was in the throes of death. He raised his head towards the sky and then said: ‘O Allāh, indeed You know that I did not love to remain in the dunyā for the sake of a stomach, nor for the sake of a private part.’”

71. Hammām ibn Yaḥyā al-‘Awdhī al-Baṣrī (d. 164 or 165H), a trustworthy narrator.

72. Qatādah ibn Di‘āmah as-Sadūsī al-Baṣrī (d. 117 or 118H), the ḥāfiẓ and mufasssīr.

73. Ḥazm ibn Abī Ḥazm al-Quṭa‘ī al-Baṣrī (d. 175H).

74. Mālik ibn Dīnār al-Baṣrī (d. c. 127H), the renowned ascetic and preacher, a companion of al-Ḥasan.

75. Al-qārī’: in the usage of the Salaf, the one who recites the Qur’ān and is known for devotion and knowledge.

76. Sallām ibn Abī Muṭī’ al-Baṣrī (d. 164H), a trustworthy narrator.

77. Ayyūb ibn Abī Tamīmah as-Sakhtiyānī al-Baṣrī (d. 131H), the trustworthy imām of Ahl as-Sunnah.

(51) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Ḥazm narrated to us, saying: I heard Mālik ibn Dīnār say: “[You are] in a murky time (zamān ash-hab)⁷⁸ in which [the way] cannot be seen, and none of you [will find the way through it] except the one possessing insight. You are in a time abounding in puffed-up braggarts — or he said: in oddities — whose tongues have swollen in their mouths, and who have sought the dunyā through the deeds of the ākhirah (the Hereafter). So beware of them for your own selves, lest they make you fall into their nets. O scholar! You are a scholar who boasts with his knowledge. O scholar! You are a scholar who eats by his knowledge. O scholar! You are a scholar who lords it over others with his knowledge. O scholar! You are a scholar who vies [with others] for abundance by his knowledge. Had this knowledge been something you sought for Allāh, that would have been seen in you and in your deeds.”

(52) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Aqīl narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Attāb Ishāq ibn Ibrāhīm narrated to us, from Ḥibbān ibn ‘Alī,⁷⁹ from Bishr ibn Rāfi‘,⁸⁰ who said: “Luqmān said to his son: ‘O my dear son, take a thousand friends, for [a thousand] is few; and do not take [even one] enemy, for [one] is many.’”

(53) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Aḥmad ibn ‘Abd Allāh ibn Ṣakhr narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād ibn Zayd narrated to us, from ‘Aṭā’ ibn as-Sā’ib, who said: “We entered upon Abū ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān as-Sulamī⁸¹ to visit him [in his illness], and we began to give him hope. He said: ‘Would I not have hope in Him, when I have fasted eighty Ramaḍāns?!’”

78. Ash-hab: grey, a mixture of white and black; that is, a time in which truth and falsehood have become mixed.

79. Ḥibbān ibn ‘Alī al-‘Anazī al-Kūfī, whom the critics graded weak.

80. Bishr ibn Rāfi‘ al-Ḥārithī, a faqīh whom the critics graded weak in ḥadīth.

81. Abū ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ‘Abd Allāh ibn Ḥabīb as-Sulamī al-Kūfī (d. after 70H), who taught the Qur’ān in the great mosque of Kūfah for some forty years.

(54) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṣakhr narrated to us, saying: Sulaym ibn Akhḍar informed us, from ‘Imrān ibn Ḥudayr, from Abū Mijlaz,⁸² who said: “The servant remains within [the time of] repentance so long as he has not beheld the Angel [of Death].”

(55) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṣakhr narrated to us, saying: Miskīn Abū Fāṭimah informed us, saying: Ḥawshab informed us, from al-Ḥasan: ﴿ثُمَّ يَتُوبُونَ مِنْ قَرِيبٍ﴾ {Then they repent soon after} (an-Nisā’ 4:17), he said: “So long as he has not reached the death rattle (lam yugharghir) of life.”⁸³

(56) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṣakhr narrated to us, from Yazīd ibn Rabiʿ,⁸⁴ from Abū Rajāʿ, from al-Ḥasan: ﴿نَقُصُّهَا مِنْ أَطْرَافِهَا﴾ {Reducing it from its extremities} (ar-Raʿd 13:41; al-Anbiyā’ 21:44), he said: “Death.”

(57) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Ṣakhr narrated to us, from Muʿtamir,⁸⁵ from Shabīb ibn ‘Abd al-Malik, who said: I heard Muqātil ibn Ḥayyān⁸⁶ say, concerning the saying of Allāh, the Blessed and Most High: ﴿سَيَمَاهُمْ فِي وُجُوهِهِمْ مِنْ أَثَرِ السُّجُودِ﴾ {Their mark is upon their faces from the trace of prostration} (al-Faṭḥ 48:29), he said: “A whiteness upon their faces on the Day of Resurrection.”

(58) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah informed us, saying: Sulaymān ibn al-Mughīrah⁸⁷ narrated to us, from Thābit, who said: “The Prophet ﷺ would fall ill and then recover. Then, when he fell ill with the illness in which

82. Abū Mijlaz Lāḥiq ibn Ḥumayd as-Sadūsī al-Baṣrī, a trustworthy Ṭābiʿī.

83. Al-gharghara: the rattling of the soul in the throat at the moment of death, after which repentance is no longer accepted.

84. Printed thus (ربيع). He is probably Yazīd ibn Zurayʿ al-Baṣrī (d. 182H), a contemporary of the other shaykhs of Ibn Ṣakhr in these chains.

85. Muʿtamir ibn Sulaymān at-Taymī al-Baṣrī (d. 187H), a trustworthy narrator.

86. Muqātil ibn Ḥayyān an-Nabaṭī al-Balkhī, a truthful narrator. He is not to be confused with Muqātil ibn Sulaymān, the mufasssīr whose narrations the scholars abandoned.

he passed away, he said: ‘I do not see this as being anything other than that which Allāh leaves no one free of, [on the way] to arriving at the Day of Resurrection.’”

(59) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Sulaymān narrated to us, from Thābit, who said: “The Messenger of Allāh ﷺ visited a sick person, and he began to turn his face away from him. Whenever he looked at him, his colour changed, and whenever he turned his face away, his colour changed. He said: ‘Did you notice that in me?’ They said: ‘Yes, O Messenger of Allāh.’ He said: ‘There is not a single vein in him except that it is in pain, and someone had come to him from his Lord and given him the glad tidings that there will be no [further] chastisement (adab) upon him.’”

(60) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Sulaymān narrated to us, from Ghaylān ibn Jarīr,⁸⁸ who said: “When Muslim ibn Yasār⁸⁹ prayed, it was as though he were a garment that had been cast down, due to how little he turned about.”

(61) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Sulaymān narrated to us, from Thābit, who said: “It has reached us that a man in Paradise will recline for seventy years, having with him his wives, his servants, and what Allāh has given him of honour and bliss. Then, when a glance of his happens to fall [elsewhere], there are wives of his whom he had not seen before that, saying: ‘The time has come for you to give us a share of yourself.’”

(62) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Hudbah narrated to us, saying: Hammām narrated to us, from Qatādah, from al-Ḥasan: “That it was said to the Prophet ﷺ: ‘This believer is dealt with severely at death, whilst this disbeliev-

87. Sulaymān ibn al-Mughīrah al-Qaysī al-Baṣrī (d. 165H), trustworthy, and among the most reliable of those who narrate from Thābit al-Bunānī.

88. Ghaylān ibn Jarīr al-Ma‘walī al-Baṣrī (d. 129H), a trustworthy narrator.

89. Muslim ibn Yasār al-Baṣrī (d. c. 100H), the devout faqīh of Baṣrah.

er is dealt with easily at death?" He said: 'Shall I not inform you about that? Indeed, the believer has sins remaining upon him, so he is recompensed for them at his death; and the disbeliever has good deeds remaining to his credit, so he is rewarded for them at his death.'"

(63) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥasan ibn Maḥbūb ibn al-Ḥasan ibn Hilāl ibn Abī Zaynab narrated to us, saying: 'Abd al-ʿAzīz ibn al-Mukhtār⁹⁰ narrated to us, saying: Abū Maslamah⁹¹ narrated to us, from Abū Naḍrah,⁹² from Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī: "That the Prophet ﷺ said to Ibn Ṣāʿid:⁹³ 'What is the soil of Paradise, O Ibn Ṣāʿid?' He said: 'Pure white flour (darmakah), [and] musk, O Abū al-Qāsim.' He said: 'He has spoken the truth.'"

(64) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Saʿīd ibn al-Walīd narrated to us, saying: Abū Tumaylah⁹⁴ narrated to us, from Mūsā ibn ʿUbaydah,⁹⁵ from Muḥammad ibn Kaʿb:⁹⁶ ﴿اعْمَلُوا ءَالَ دَاوُدَ شُكْرًا﴾ {*Work, O family of Dāwūd, in gratitude*} (Saba' 34:13), he said: "Gratitude is having taqwā of Allāh and acting in obedience to Him."

(65) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū Bakr al-Quṭaʿī, Muḥammad ibn Saʿīd,⁹⁷ narrated to us, saying: Abū Tumaylah narrated to us, from al-Ḥusayn ibn Wāqīd,⁹⁸ from Yazīd an-Naḥwī,⁹⁹ from ʿIkrimah, from Ibn ʿAbbās: ﴿يعْلَمُونَ﴾

90. ʿAbd al-ʿAzīz ibn al-Mukhtār al-Baṣrī, a trustworthy narrator.

91. Abū Maslamah Saʿīd ibn Yazīd al-Azdī al-Baṣrī, a trustworthy narrator.

92. Abū Naḍrah al-Mundhir ibn Mālīk al-ʿAbdī al-Baṣrī (d. 108 or 109H), a trustworthy Ṭābiʿī.

93. Ibn Ṣāʿid, also called Ibn Ṣayyād: the Jewish youth of al-Madīnah whose affair the Prophet ﷺ tested, and whom some of the Companions suspected of being the Dajjāl.

94. Abū Tumaylah Yaḥyā ibn Wāḍiḥ al-Marwazī, a trustworthy narrator.

95. Mūsā ibn ʿUbaydah ar-Rabadhī, whom the critics graded weak.

96. Muḥammad ibn Kaʿb al-Quraṣī al-Madanī, the trustworthy Ṭābiʿī and scholar of tafsīr.

97. He is the same Muḥammad ibn Saʿīd ibn al-Walīd of the previous chain.

98. Al-Ḥusayn ibn Wāqīd al-Marwazī (d. 159H), the qāḍī of Marw.

99. Yazīd ibn Abī Saʿīd an-Naḥwī al-Marwazī (d. 131H), a trustworthy narrator.

﴿يَعْلَمُونَ ظَهْرًا مِّنَ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا﴾ {*They know what is apparent of the worldly life*} (ar-Rūm 30:7), he said: “When to sow, when to plant, when to harvest, and things of that sort.”

(66) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: ‘Alī ibn ‘Uthmān al-Lāḥiqī narrated to us, saying: Juwayriyah ibn Bashīr narrated to us, from al-Ḥasan: ﴿يَعْلَمُونَ ظَهْرًا مِّنَ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا﴾ {*They know what is apparent of the worldly life*} (ar-Rūm 30:7), [to the end of] the verse. So al-Ḥasan said: “By Allāh, the knowledge of one of them regarding his dunyā has reached [the point] that he turns a dirham over upon his fingernail and tells you its weight, [yet] he does not know how to pray properly!”

(67) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Abū Ḥafṣ narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Āṣim¹⁰⁰ narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn ‘Umārah ibn ‘Amr ibn Ḥazm narrated to us, from ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān — he is Abū Ṭuwālah¹⁰¹ — “That a gift was brought to the Prophet ﷺ. He looked in the house for something to place it in, but did not find anything. So he said: ‘Place it upon the ground (al-ḥaḍīd), for if it [the dunyā] were equal, in the sight of Allāh, to the wing of a gnat, He would not have given a disbeliever a single drink from it.”

(68) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd¹⁰² narrated to me, saying: Ṣāliḥ ibn Mūsā¹⁰³ narrated to me, from Mu‘āwiyah ibn Ishāq, from Sa‘īd ibn Jubayr, who said: “That I be entrusted with a house full of pearls is more beloved to me than that I be entrusted with a beautiful woman.”

100. Abū ‘Āṣim an-Nabīl aḍ-Ḍaḥḥāk ibn Makhlad ash-Shaybānī al-Baṣrī (d. 212H), a trustworthy and precise narrator.

101. Abū Ṭuwālah ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Ma‘mar al-Anṣārī al-Madanī (d. 134H), a trustworthy Ṭābi‘ī.

102. Suwayd ibn Sa‘īd al-Ḥadathānī (d. 240H), one of the shaykhs of Muslim. He lost his sight in old age, after which his narrations were criticised.

103. Ṣāliḥ ibn Mūsā aṭ-Ṭalḥī al-Kūfī, whose narrations the critics abandoned.

(69) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Abū al-Muḥayyāh Yaḥyā ibn Ya‘lā narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-Malik ibn ‘Umayr,¹⁰⁴ who said: “It was said to Abū Wā’il: ‘Have you not seen a Khārījī who came out against the people in the market, so the people of the market set upon him and beat him with chairs until they killed him?’ So Abū Wā’il said: ‘By Allāh, this one did not bring honour to a religion for Allāh, nor did he redress the grievance of anyone wronged. This — by your father¹⁰⁵ — is [sheer] ruin (al-ḥayn)!’”¹⁰⁶

(70) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd ibn Sa‘īd narrated to me, saying: Abū al-Muḥayyāh narrated to me, from ‘Abd al-Malik ibn ‘Umayr, who said: “A man said to his son: ‘O my son, display despair of what is with the people, for that is [true] richness. Beware of seeking your needs from them, for that is present poverty. When you stand for the prayer, perfect the wuḍū’ and then pray the prayer of one bidding farewell. If you are able to be better today than you were yesterday, and better tomorrow than you are today, then do so. And beware of that for which one must make excuses.”

(71) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: al-Muṭṭalib narrated to us — meaning Ibn Ziyād — from Zayd ibn ‘Alī,¹⁰⁷ who said: “A man from the Qadariyyah¹⁰⁸ came to him and said: ‘O Abū al-Ḥusayn, I wish to ask you about a single matter.’ He said: ‘Does Allāh, the Blessed and Most High, love to be disobeyed?’ So Zayd ibn ‘Alī said: ‘Is He then disobeyed by force [against His Will]?’¹⁰⁹ He said: ‘So the man sped off from before him, fleeing.’”

104. ‘Abd al-Malik ibn ‘Umayr al-Kūfī (d. 136H).

105. “By your father”: an expression customary in the speech of the Arabs, not intended as an actual oath.

106. The last word is printed as الحسین. I have read it as الحین (ruin, perdition), which fits the context; this reading should be checked against the manuscript.

107. Zayd ibn ‘Alī ibn al-Ḥusayn ibn ‘Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib, Abū al-Ḥusayn, killed in 122H.

108. The Qadariyyah: the sect that denied the Divine Decree (al-qadar), claiming that the servant’s actions occur independently of the Will of Allāh.

(72) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Muḥammad ibn Marwān al-Baṣrī narrated to us, from Kathīr Abū al-Faḍl, from ash-Shaʿbī,¹¹⁰ who said: “Seventy thousand from [the men of] ʿAlī and Muʿāwiyah were killed on the day of Ṣiffin.”¹¹¹

(73) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn ʿUmar narrated to us, saying: I heard al-Ḥasan say: “All good is in these two words: holding fast to what you have been commanded, and desisting from what you have been forbidden.”

(74) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Fuḍayl ibn ʿIyāḍ¹¹² narrated to us, from Hishām ibn Ḥassān, who said: “We were with al-Ḥasan, and he stopped by a grave and said: ‘O people! A life whose end is this — what good is there in its beginning?!’”

(75) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, from ʿAbd ar-Raḥīm ibn Sulaymān ar-Rāzī, who said: “We were with Sufyān ath-Thawrī. Whenever a man came to him seeking knowledge, he would ask him: ‘Do you have a means of livelihood?’ If he informed him that he had sufficiency, he would command him to seek knowledge; and if he did not have sufficiency, he would command him to seek a livelihood.”

(76) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Abū ʿAwn al-Ḥakam ibn Sinān narrated to us, from Mālīk ibn Dīnār, who said: “It is written in the Tawrah: ‘As you deal, so shall you be dealt with; and as you sow, so shall you reap.’”

109. That is: if disobedience occurred without Allāh having willed it, then He would be overpowered in His dominion, which is impossible. Ahl as-Sunnah distinguish between what Allāh loves and is pleased with, and what He wills to occur in His creation.

110. ʿĀmir ibn Sharāḥīl ash-Shaʿbī al-Kūfī (d. c. 104H), the renowned Tābiʿī and faqīh.

111. The way of Ahl as-Sunnah regarding what occurred between the Companions is to withhold from delving into it, to believe that they were mujtahids, and to supplicate for all of them.

112. Al-Fuḍayl ibn ʿIyāḍ at-Tamīmī (d. 187H), the renowned ascetic and worshipper of al-Ḥaram, a trustworthy imām.

(77) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Khālīd an-Nīlī narrated to me — at ar-Raḥbah, Raḥbat Ṭawq¹¹³ — he said: al-Walīd ibn Muslim¹¹⁴ narrated to us, from Mālīk ibn Anas,¹¹⁵ who said: ‘Umar ibn ‘Abd al-‘Azīz¹¹⁶ said: “I have not told a single lie since I first tied my izār upon myself.”¹¹⁷

(78) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad narrated to us, saying: al-Walīd narrated to us, from Thawr,¹¹⁸ from Khālīd ibn Ma‘dān,¹¹⁹ who said: “Whoever narrates to the people what his eyes have seen, or his ears have heard, or his hands have taken hold of, then he is from among *الَّذِينَ يُحِبُّونَ أَنْ تَشِيعَ الْفَاحِشَةُ فِي الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا* {those who love that immorality should spread among those who believe} (an-Nūr 24:19).”

(79) Abū Ḥātim narrated to me, saying: Muḥammad narrated to me, saying: al-Walīd narrated to us, from Sa‘īd ibn ‘Abd al-‘Azīz,¹²⁰ “That one of the Salaf said to a companion of his, who had become short-tempered over some matter: ‘If you are able to change your character for the better, then do so. Otherwise, our character has room enough for whatever your own character has become too narrow for.’”

(80) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad narrated to me, saying: al-Walīd narrated to us, from ‘Uthmān ibn Abī al-‘Ātikah, “That Abū Muslim al-Khawlānī¹²¹ bought a mule, and his wife said to him: ‘Supplicate to Allāh for blessing in it for us.’ He said: ‘O Allāh, bless it for us.’ By the morning it had

113. Raḥbat Mālīk ibn Ṭawq: a town on the Euphrates.

114. Al-Walīd ibn Muslim ad-Dimashqī (d. 195H), the ḥāfiẓ of Shām. He is trustworthy, though known for tadlīs.

115. Mālīk ibn Anas al-Aṣḥaḥī (d. 179H), the Imām of Dār al-Hijrah.

116. ‘Umar ibn ‘Abd al-‘Azīz al-Umawī (d. 101H), the rightly-guided khalīfah.

117. That is: since he reached maturity.

118. Thawr ibn Yazīd al-Kalā‘ī al-Ḥimṣī (d. c. 150H).

119. Khālīd ibn Ma‘dān al-Kalā‘ī al-Ḥimṣī (d. 103H), the trustworthy and devout Tābi‘ī.

120. Sa‘īd ibn ‘Abd al-‘Azīz at-Tanūkhī ad-Dimashqī (d. 167H), the trustworthy imām of the people of Shām in his time.

121. Abū Muslim ‘Abd Allāh ibn Thuwab al-Khawlānī (d. c. 62H), the renowned ascetic of Shām.

died. Then he bought a second mule, and she said the like of that to him, and by the morning it had died. Then he bought the third, and she said: ‘Abū Muslim, supplicate to Allāh for blessing in it for us.’ So he said: ‘Be quiet, O foolish woman! O Allāh, let us have the enjoyment of it.’”

(81) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad narrated to me, saying: al-Walīd narrated to us, from Ibn Jābir:¹²² He heard that al-Qāsim ibn Mukhaymirah¹²³ disliked that a man from among his brothers should say to him: “May Allāh grant [us] enjoyment of you.” He said: “It is only a newly-invented supplication.”

(82) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad narrated to me, saying: al-Walīd narrated to us, from Sa‘īd ibn ‘Abd al-‘Azīz, “That Abū Muslim al-Khawlānī used to say at the time of fighting: ‘What [blame] is upon me, when I have put on my armour? Today I shall die having given my utmost.’”

(83) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, from Mu‘tamir, from his father,¹²⁴ who said: “The clothing of Bakr ibn ‘Abd Allāh al-Muzanī would reach [the value of] four thousand [dirhams].”

(84) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: ‘Ubayd ibn Abī al-Wasīm narrated to us, from Salmān Abū Shaddād, who said: “I used to play with al-Ḥusayn ibn ‘Alī with al-madāḥī.¹²⁵ When his stone hit [the mark], I would carry him, and when my stone hit, I said: ‘Carry me as I carried you.’ He said: ‘It is not fitting that you should ride upon a part of the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ.’”

122. ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Yazīd ibn Jābir ad-Dimashqī (d. 153 or 154H), a trustworthy narrator.

123. Al-Qāsim ibn Mukhaymirah al-Hamdānī (d. 100H), a trustworthy Kūfan Tābi‘ī who settled in Shām.

124. Sulaymān ibn Ṭarkhān at-Taymī al-Baṣrī (d. 143H), the trustworthy and devout worshipper.

125. Al-madāḥī: flat stones rolled towards a pit or mark in a game.

(85) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Khālīd ibn Yazīd ibn Abī Mālīk¹²⁶ narrated to us, from his father, who said: “Three are to be honoured: the one who has grown grey in Islām, the just ruler, and knowledge, wherever it is found, whether with an old man or a youth.”

(86) Abū Ḥātim narrated to me, saying: Suwayd narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Ḥumrān narrated to us, from Ibn ‘Awn,¹²⁷ from Muḥammad:¹²⁸ “That a man came to al-Aḥnaf¹²⁹ asking him [for charity]. He said: ‘I see that you are healthy.’ Then he said: ‘Hush! Allāh knew that this one would ask.’”¹³⁰

(87) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Buzay‘ Abū Khāzim narrated to us, from aḍ-Ḍaḥḥāk:¹³¹ ﴿فَخَانَاهُمَا﴾ {But they betrayed them} (at-Taḥrīm 66:10), he said: “They went about with tale-carrying (namīmah). Whenever revelation came to the two [Prophets], they would disclose it to the polytheists.”¹³²

And I saw aḍ-Ḍaḥḥāk praying in a lubbādah,¹³³ with his hand inside it.

126. Khālīd ibn Yazīd ibn Abī Mālīk ad-Dimashqī, whom the critics graded weak. His father, Yazīd ibn ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn Abī Mālīk, was a qāḍī of Damascus.

127. ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Awn al-Baṣrī (d. 150H), the trustworthy and precise imām.

128. Muḥammad ibn Sīrīn.

129. Al-Aḥnaf ibn Qays at-Tamīmī (d. c. 67H), the chief of Banū Tamīm, proverbial for his forbearance.

130. Mah: a word of restraint, “stop” or “hush”. He was apparently checking himself for his first remark.

131. Aḍ-Ḍaḥḥāk ibn Muzāḥim al-Hilālī (d. c. 105H), the mufasssīr.

132. Referring to the wives of Nūḥ and Lūṭ. Their betrayal was in the religion, not in chastity; Ibn ‘Abbās said: “The wife of a Prophet never committed fornication.”

133. Lubbādah: a cloak of thick felt.

(88) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to us, saying: ‘Abd Allāh ibn Bukayr al-Ghanawī narrated to me, from Muḥammad ibn Sūqah,¹³⁴ from ‘Awn ibn ‘Abd Allāh, concerning His saying: ﴿لَأَقْعُدَنَّ لَهُمْ صِرَاطَكَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ﴾ {I will surely sit in wait for them upon Your Straight Path} (al-A‘rāf 7:16), he said: “The road to Makkah.”

(89) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to us, saying: al-Muṭṭalib narrated to us, from al-Qāsim ibn Muḥammad, from al-Walid ibn Sarī‘, from ‘Amr ibn Ḥurayth,¹³⁵ who said: “I saw ‘Alī striking the people with the dirrah¹³⁶ until he reached my door. I said: ‘What is the matter, O Commander of the Believers?’ He said: ‘I used to think that the ruler wrongs the people, yet [I find that] the people wrong the ruler!’”

(90) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: ‘Ā’idh narrated to us — the seller of Harawī [cloth]¹³⁷ — from a man from Banū Hāshim, who said: “When ‘Alī ate food, he loved that it be eaten with him, except for pomegranates, for he would eat them alone, and he would eat them with their pith, saying: ‘Indeed, in every pomegranate there is a seed from Paradise.’”

(91) Abū Ḥātim narrated to me, saying: Suwayd narrated to us, saying: ‘Amr ibn Thābit¹³⁸ narrated to us, from ‘Aqīṣā — Abū Ḥātim said: and he is Abū Sa‘īd; al-A‘mash and Fiṭr narrated from ‘Aqīṣā, and ‘Aqīṣā was from the Shī‘ah — from ‘Alī, who said: “My being a minister (wazīr) for you is better than my being a ruler (amīr) over you.”

(92) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym ibn Ḥammād¹³⁹ narrated to me, saying: ‘Abd Allāh ibn al-Ḥārith narrated to us, from Ḥafṣah bint Zayd, who said: “I entered upon Sālim — and he was my paternal uncle — and asked him

134. Muḥammad ibn Sūqah al-Kūfī, a trustworthy and devout narrator.

135. ‘Amr ibn Ḥurayth al-Makhzūmī, a young Companion who settled in Kūfah.

136. Ad-dirrah: a leather whip carried by the rulers for discipline.

about what the women had newly introduced, of some of them lying with one another. He said: ‘By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, the two of them will come on the Day of Resurrection as two fornicators, or [as] two who committed the deed of the people of Lūt; and indeed the lūṭiyyah of women is like the lūṭiyyah of men.’”

(93) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Suwayd narrated to me, saying: Ḍimām ibn Ismā‘īl al-Ma‘āfirī narrated to us, from al-Layth,¹⁴⁰ who said: “‘Abd Allāh ibn Nāfi‘ wrote to me:¹⁴¹ ‘Do not listen, from our storytellers (quṣṣāṣ),¹⁴² to the ḥadīth with which you are being beguiled.’”

(94) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym narrated to us, saying: ‘Abd al-Malik ibn aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ narrated to me, from Bakkār ibn ‘Abd Allāh, from Wahn ibn Munabbih, who said: “Indeed, a bribe covers the eye of the wise man; so what then of its effect upon the ignorant?”

(95) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym narrated to me, saying: Ḥusayn ibn Zayd narrated to me, from ‘Alī, from Ja‘far ibn Muḥammad,¹⁴³ from his father, from ‘Alī: “That nabīdh would be steeped for him on the two ‘īds.”¹⁴⁴

139. Nu‘aym ibn Ḥammād al-Marwazī (d. 228H), the ḥāfiẓ who died in prison during the Miḥnah for refusing to say that the Qur’ān is created.

137. Al-Harawī: a kind of cloth from Harāt.

138. ‘Amr ibn Thābit ibn Abī al-Miqdām al-Kūfī, whom the critics graded weak and accused of rafḍ.

140. Al-Layth ibn Sa‘d al-Fahmī (d. 175H), the imām of Egypt.

141. Reading the printed كُتِبَ إِلَيَّ as katab ilayya, “he wrote to me”.

142. Al-quṣṣāṣ: popular preachers who related stories and reports to the common people, often without verification.

143. Ja‘far ibn Muḥammad aṣ-Ṣādiq (d. 148H), who narrates from his father, Muḥammad ibn ‘Alī al-Bāqir.

144. Nabīdh: water in which dates or raisins have been steeped, drunk before it ferments. It is lawful so long as it has not become intoxicating.

(96) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym narrated to me, from Ḥusayn ibn Zayd, from ‘Umar ibn ‘Alī ibn Ḥusayn, from his father:¹⁴⁵ “That he used to wear a cloak [costing] two hundred and fifty, and he would recite: ﴿قُلْ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِينَةَ اللَّهِ﴾ {Say: Who has forbidden the adornment of Allāh [which He has produced for His servants]?} (al-A‘rāf 7:32), [to the end of] the verse.”

(97) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym narrated to us, saying: Sulaymān ibn Ḥajar aṣ-Ṣan‘ānī narrated to me, saying: “I did not see anyone in Yemen better in dress than Wahb ibn Munabbih.”

(98) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym narrated to me, saying: Sulaymān narrated to us, saying: my paternal uncle narrated to me — and he kept constant company with Wahb ibn Munabbih — he said: “When Wahb ibn Munabbih prayed at night, he would place a large bowl (jafnah) beside him, containing honey, qubbayṭ, sugar and sweets. He would pray a little, then sit and eat, then pray a little, then eat from it; he would do that many times in the night.”

Abū Ḥātim said: “Al-qubbayṭ is the nāṭif into which pine nuts are put.”¹⁴⁶

(99) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Nu‘aym narrated to us, saying: ‘Abd al-Wahhāb ibn Hammām¹⁴⁷ narrated to us, from Ibn Jurayj,¹⁴⁸ from Ibn Abī Muḥaykah,¹⁴⁹ from Ibn ‘Abbās, who said: “Horses were wild like the rest of the wild animals. Then, when Allāh, the Mighty and Majestic, commanded Ibrāhīm to raise the foundations of the House — there is lengthy speech in it¹⁵⁰

145. ‘Alī ibn al-Ḥusayn ibn ‘Alī, Zayn al-‘Ābidīn (d. 93 or 94H).

146. An-nāṭif: a thick, chewy confection of honey or sugar, similar to nougat.

147. ‘Abd al-Wahhāb ibn Hammām aṣ-Ṣan‘ānī, the brother of ‘Abd ar-Razzāq.

148. ‘Abd al-Malik ibn ‘Abd al-‘Azīz ibn Jurayj al-Makkī (d. 150H).

149. ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Ubayd Allāh ibn Abī Muḥaykah al-Makkī (d. 117H), a trustworthy Ṭābi‘ī.

150. That is: the report contains a longer passage at this point, which has been abridged.

— Allāh gave Ismā‘īl mastery over their forelocks and made them submissive to him. So ride them and keep them, for they are blessed, and they are the inheritance of your father Ismā‘īl.”

(100) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: ‘Alī ibn Ma‘bad ibn Shaddād narrated to us, saying: Abū al-Maliḥ¹⁵¹ narrated to us, from Maymūn ibn Mihrān,¹⁵² who said: “Leave off disputation (al-mirā’), due to how little good there is in it.”¹⁵³

(101) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: the scribe of al-Layth¹⁵⁴ narrated to us, saying: Ibrāhīm ibn Sa‘d¹⁵⁵ narrated to me, from Muḥammad ibn Ishāq,¹⁵⁶ from someone who narrated to him, from al-Ḥasan ibn Abī al-Ḥasan: “That a man from his acquaintances came to him to call him to a funeral. He then departed, and his route passed by the man’s house. When he had gone past his house, one of his companions said: ‘So-and-so invited you, and this is his house.’ He remained silent towards him. So he said: ‘O Abū Sa‘d, do you not know the right of an invitation?!’ He said: ‘O shutur!’ — in Persian.”¹⁵⁷

(102) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Ibn Abī Maryam¹⁵⁸ narrated to us, saying: al-Layth ibn Sa‘d informed us, saying: Abū Ṣāliḥ al-Khursī informed us: “There was among them in ‘Irāq a girl who became pregnant when she was nine years old.”

151. Abū al-Maliḥ al-Ḥasan ibn ‘Umar ar-Raqqī (d. 181H).

152. Maymūn ibn Mihrān al-Jazarī (d. 117H), the faqīh of al-Jazīrah.

153. Printed المراء. I have read it as المراء (disputation), which best fits the sense.

154. Abū Ṣāliḥ ‘Abd Allāh ibn Ṣāliḥ al-Juhanī al-Miṣrī (d. 222H), the scribe of al-Layth ibn Sa‘d.

155. Ibrāhīm ibn Sa‘d az-Zuhrī al-Madanī (d. 183H), a trustworthy narrator.

156. Muḥammad ibn Ishāq ibn Yasār al-Madanī (d. 150 or 151H), the author of al-Maghāzī.

157. Shutur: Persian for “camel”, said as a rebuke for the man’s lack of understanding, since he had been called to a funeral, not invited to a meal.

158. Sa‘id ibn al-Ḥakam ibn Abī Maryam al-Miṣrī (d. 224H), a trustworthy and precise narrator.

(103) Abū Ḥātim informed us, saying: Aṣḡagh ibn al-Faraj¹⁵⁹ informed me, from Ibn Wahb,¹⁶⁰ who said: Ibn Lahī‘ah¹⁶¹ informed me, from ‘Umārah ibn Ghaziyyah, who said: “I asked ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn al-Qāsim¹⁶² about the name of Abū Bakr aṣ-Ṣiddīq. He said: “Atīq, and Mu‘taq.””¹⁶³

(104) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Aṣḡagh narrated to us, saying: Ibn Wahb informed me, saying: Sa‘īd ibn Abī Ayyūb¹⁶⁴ informed me, from ‘Aṭā’ ibn Dīnār:¹⁶⁵ “That a man came to the Prophet ﷺ and said: ‘Which of the two parents has the greater right over me?’ He said: ‘She who carried him between [her] two sides, suckled him with [her] two breasts, nursed him upon [her] two thighs, and ransomed him with [her] two parents.’”¹⁶⁶

(105) Abū Ḥātim narrated to us, saying: Aṣḡagh narrated to us, from Ibn Wahb, who said: Quraysh ibn Ḥayyān¹⁶⁷ informed me, from Thābit al-Bunānī, who said: “When we came to Anas ibn Mālīk, and he saw us, he would call for fragrant oil and wipe his hands with it, in order to shake hands with his brothers.”

And all praise is for Allāh, first and last.



159. Aṣḡagh ibn al-Faraj al-Miṣrī (d. 225H), the Mālīkī faqīh, a trustworthy narrator.

160. ‘Abd Allāh ibn Wahb al-Miṣrī (d. 197H), the trustworthy imām and companion of Mālīk.

161. ‘Abd Allāh ibn Lahī‘ah al-Ḥaḍramī al-Miṣrī (d. 174H), the qāḍī of Egypt. His narrations were weakened, though the scholars held those of ‘Abd Allāh ibn Wahb and the other ‘Abādīlah from him to be stronger.

162. ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn al-Qāsim ibn Muḥammad ibn Abī Bakr aṣ-Ṣiddīq (d. 126H), a descendant of Abū Bakr.

163. Abū Bakr’s name is well known to be ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Uthmān; ‘Atīq is a title (laqab) by which he was known.

164. Sa‘īd ibn Abī Ayyūb al-Khuzā‘ī al-Miṣrī (d. 161H), a trustworthy narrator.

165. ‘Aṭā’ ibn Dīnār al-Hudhalī al-Miṣrī, a Ṭābi‘ī.

166. That is: out of her love for him, she would say, “May my father and mother be your ransom.”

167. Quraysh ibn Ḥayyān al-‘Ijlī al-Baṣrī, a trustworthy narrator.

The Audition Note (Samāʿ)

The owner of this juzʿ, ash-Shaykh Abū Muḥammad ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān ibn Aḥmad ibn ʿAlī ibn Ṣābir as-Sulamī,¹⁶⁸ completed hearing it, from its beginning, with ash-Shaykh Abū Ṭāhir Muḥammad ibn al-Ḥusayn (raḍiyallāhu ʿanhu), by his own reading, after collating it against a copy that belonged to the father of his shaykh, in which is the record of his hearing it from his shaykh. There heard it along with him his son, Abū al-Maʿālī ʿAbd Allāh ibn ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān, Khiyarat Allāh,¹⁶⁹ and Abū al-Ḥasan ʿAlī ibn Mahdī ibn al-Mufarrij al-Hilālī, and the writer of the names, Aḥmad ibn Rāshid ibn Muḥammad al-Qurashī, on Friday, the fourth of Shaʿbān, in the year five hundred and six.

Two Appended Ḥadīths

[1] Ash-Shaykh Abū al-Faraj Muḥammad ibn ʿAlī ibn ʿAbd as-Salām al-Armanāzī (raḍiyallāhu ʿanhu) narrated to us, dictating to us from his memory, whilst my son ʿAbd Allāh was listening, saying: Abū Bakr Aḥmad ibn ʿAlī ibn Thābit al-Khaṭīb al-Ḥāfiẓ al-Baghdādī¹⁷⁰ informed us, saying: Abū ʿUmar ʿAbd al-Wāḥid ibn Muḥammad ibn ʿAbd Allāh ibn Mahdī informed us, saying: al-Ḥusayn ibn Ismāʿīl al-Maḥāmili¹⁷¹ narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn ʿAmr ibn Abī Madhʿūr narrated to us, saying: Ibn Abī Ḥāzim narrated to us, saying: my father¹⁷² informed me, from Sahl ibn Saʿd, who said: the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ said: “The people will not cease to be upon good so long as they hasten the breaking of the fast.”

[2] Abū al-Faraj narrated to us, dictating from his memory, whilst my son ʿAbd Allāh was listening, saying: Abū aṭ-Ṭāhir al-Musharraf ibn ʿAlī ibn al-Khiḍr ibn ʿAbd Allāh, known as Ibn at-Tammār, narrated to us — at Ṣūr — from his own

168. He is the unnamed student who speaks in the opening chain: “by my reading [it] to him.”

169. Printed thus (خيرة الله), apparently a title or second name.

170. Al-Khaṭīb al-Baghdādī (d. 463H), the ḥāfiẓ and author of Tārīkh Baghdād.

171. Al-Qāḍī Abū ʿAbd Allāh ibn al-Ḥusayn ibn Ismāʿīl al-Maḥāmili al-Baghdādī (d. 330H).

words and memory, and he wrote it for me in his own hand, saying: Abū al-‘Abbās Ismā‘īl ibn ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān ibn ‘Umar ibn an-Naḥḥās informed us, saying: Abū Muḥammad al-Ḥasan ibn Rashīq informed us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Ḥafṣ aṭ-Ṭālaqānī narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Kathīr al-‘Abdī¹⁷³ narrated to us, saying: Sufyān ath-Thawrī narrated to us — or: informed us — from Abū az-Zubayr,¹⁷⁴ from Jābir, who said: the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ said: “What is between my grave and my minbar is a garden from the gardens of Paradise.”

172. Abū Ḥāzim Salamah ibn Dīnār al-Madanī, the trustworthy and devout Tābi‘ī.

173. Muḥammad ibn Kathīr al-‘Abdī al-Baṣrī (d. 223H), a trustworthy narrator.

174. Abū az-Zubayr Muḥammad ibn Muslim ibn Tadrus al-Makkī (d. 126H), the companion of Jābir ibn ‘Abd Allāh.

Glossary

ākhirah: the Hereafter, the everlasting life after death.

dunyā: this worldly life, with its wealth, pleasures and adornments.

ḥāfiẓ: a master of ḥadīth, known for the breadth and precision of his memory.

isnād: the chain of narrators through whom a report is transmitted.

al-jarḥ wat-ta'dīl: the science of criticising and accrediting narrators.

juz': a short, self-contained collection of narrations.

qārī': a reciter of the Qur'ān; in early usage, a man known for devotion and knowledge.

samā': audition: hearing a book read before a shaykh, recorded in the margins of manuscripts.

Tābi'ī: one who met a Companion of the Prophet ﷺ as a believer and died upon Islām (pl. Tābi'ūn / Tābi'īn).

taqwā: dutiful fear of Allāh, shielding oneself from His punishment through obedience.

zuhd: abstinence: turning away from the excesses of the dunyā for the sake of the ākhirah.